الرواد الرقميون
DiGiLiANS

وزارة الاتصالات وتكنولوجيا المعلومات

Digilians

Freelancing MODULE

WORKING ON FREELANCING PLATFORMS

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Participant's Manual

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Module 1: Introduction to Freelancing Platforms

What are Freelancing Platforms?

Freelancing platforms are online marketplaces that connect freelancers with clients needing specific projects or tasks. They offer a structured and secure space for finding work, submitting proposals, managing communication, and processing payments.

Types of Freelancing Platforms

- 1. General Platforms – open to multiple professions and industries (e.g., Upwork, Freelancer, Guru, PeoplePerHour).
- 2. Niche Platforms – specialized in particular fields like design or writing (e.g., 99Designs, ProBlogger, DesignCrowd).
- 3. Microservice Platforms – focused on small, fixed-price tasks (e.g., Khamsat, Kwork, Fiverr).
- 4. Arabic Platforms – regional sites tailored for Arabic-speaking freelancers (e.g., Mostaql, Ureed, Freelance Yard).

Top Rated Freelancing Platforms

- Upwork – the world's largest freelancing marketplace.
- Freelancer.com – great for project-based bidding.
- Mostaql – popular Arabic-language freelancing site in MENA.
- Khamsat – ideal for beginners offering microservices starting at $5.

Activity: Explore the Platforms

Visit at least two freelancing platforms. Observe what services are most in demand, how freelancers write their profiles, and what payment or service fees each platform applies.

Module 2: How Freelancing Platforms Work

Freelancing platforms operate using structured processes that make it easy for clients and freelancers to collaborate. However, the workflow differs slightly depending on whether you're applying for jobs or listing predefined services.

Project-Based Platforms (Job Posting Model)

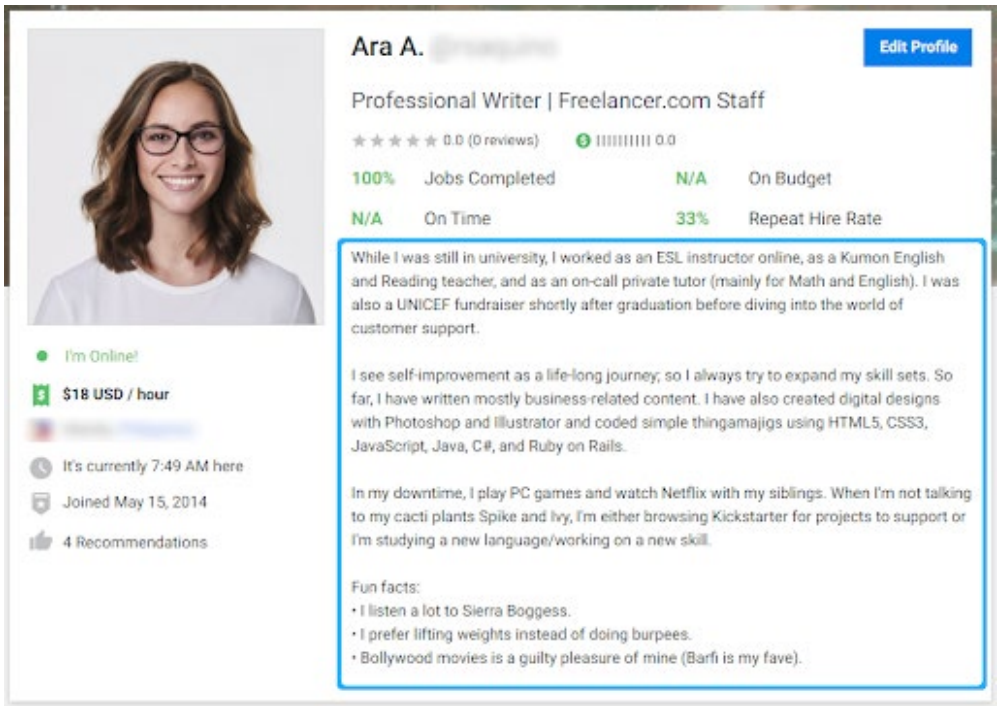
- 1. Log in or create an account on the platform.
- 2. Build a professional profile highlighting your skills, experience, and samples.
- 3. Browse job listings relevant to your expertise.
- 4. Submit a customized proposal for each job with your price and estimated delivery time.
- 5. Discuss the details with the client and start the project once hired.
- 6. Deliver the work through the platform to ensure safe payment.
- 7. Receive payment once the client approves the submission.

Service-Based Platforms (Listing Model)

- 1. Log in or sign up as a seller.
- 2. Create a clear and engaging profile page.
- 3. Add your services (with descriptions, pricing, and samples).
- 4. Promote your listings and respond to client messages.
- 5. Deliver projects on time and maintain communication.
- 6. Receive payments and feedback through the platform.

Activity: Create a Winning Freelancing Profile

Using your chosen platform (Upwork or Mostaql), build a professional profile. Include a photo, clear title, summary of your experience, list of skills, and at least two samples of your work.



Module 3: Building and Managing Your Freelancing Services

How to Create a Service on Khamsat or Similar Platforms

Khamsat is a leading Arabic microservice platform where freelancers offer small, specific services starting at $5. When creating your service, make sure to provide all necessary details clearly and professionally.

- 1. Service Title – clear and descriptive (e.g., 'I will design a business logo in 24 hours').
- 2. Category – select the correct area such as design, writing, or marketing.
- 3. Description – describe the task, process, and value for the client.
- 4. Gallery – add high-quality images or videos to illustrate your work.
- 5. Price – choose a fair rate and mention optional upgrades.
- 6. Delivery Time – define how long you need to complete the order.
- 7. Keywords – include relevant search terms to make your service visible.
- 8. Buyer Instructions – specify the details you require before starting.
- 9. Add-ons – provide extra options like faster delivery or additional revisions.
- 10. Terms – confirm the platform's policies before publishing your service.

Tips for an Effective Freelancing Service Page

- Write in clear, active language ('I will design', 'I can create').
- Use high-quality visuals and relevant examples.
- Focus on what clients will gain from your service.
- Keep descriptions concise but informative.
- End with a friendly call to action such as 'Contact me before placing an order'.

Activity: Create Your Freelancing Service

Log into Khamsat or Kwork and create one full service listing including title, images, and description. Ask a peer or mentor to review your page and suggest improvements.

Module 4: Payment Tools and Getting Started Without Experience

Common Payment Tools on Freelancing Platforms

- Payoneer – widely accepted for international transactions and used by Upwork.
- PayPal – common for freelancers worldwide with fast transfers.
- Wise (formerly TransferWise) – offers low-fee global transfers directly to bank accounts.
- Local Bank Transfers – available for regional Arabic platforms like Mostaql and Khamsat.

Conditions and Platform Policies

- Always read the payment and refund policies before starting a project.
- Check withdrawal limits and supported currencies.
- Understand dispute resolution procedures in case of client conflicts.
- Be aware of platform service fees (usually 10–20% per transaction).

How to Start Freelancing Without Experience

- 1. Identify your key skills and areas of interest.
- 2. Build a mock project or case study that demonstrates your capabilities.
- 3. Offer your services at competitive rates initially to build reputation.
- 4. Request testimonials from early clients to strengthen your profile.
- 5. Keep learning and improving your portfolio regularly.

• Tool/Method	• Description	• Popular Platforms
• Escrow	• Client funds are held by the platform and released upon project completion.	• Upwork, Freelancer
• Milestone Payments	• Payments are divided by project phases or deliverables.	• Upwork, Freelancer
• Hourly Tracking Tools	• Tracks freelancer's time via screenshot/time-logging software.	• Upwork (Time Tracker)
• Direct Pay/Wallet	• Platform wallet stores earnings before withdrawal.	• Fiverr, Toptal, Guru
• Invoicing Systems	• Freelancers generate invoices within the platform.	• Freelancer, PeoplePerHour
• Payment Gateways	• Includes PayPal, Payoneer, Bank Transfer, Wise, Skrill, etc.	• All major platforms

• • Platform	• Payment Conditions	• Payout Time	• Fees (%)
• Upwork	• - Escrow for fixed-price- Time-tracker for hourly contracts	• 5–10 days	• 5–20% (tiered by earnings)
• Freelancer	• - Milestone-based; client funds must be deposited upfront	• Instant (after release)	• 10% (projects), 20% (services)
• Toptal	• - Vetting process, premium clients, direct contracts	• 2–3 weeks	• Custom (platform takes a cut)
• PeoplePerHour	• - Deposit/milestones, custom quotes	• After approval	• 20% (first $700), then 7.5%
• Guru	• - WorkRooms and SafePay system (escrow-like)	• Weekly	• 5–9%
• 99Designs	• - Design contests and direct 1-on-1 projects	• 5–10 days after project	• 5–15%

Activity: Research and Reflect

Research at least two freelancing platforms that match your field of study or expertise. Then answer the following: Which platform fits your goals best? What types of projects can you start with immediately? What are your next three steps to begin freelancing successfully?

NOTES

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